Job-Skills Mismatch Among College Graduates. A Digital Job-Matching System.

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Introduction

Finding the right job after college can be difficult when a person's skills and qualifications do not match the requirements of available jobs. This is known as job-skills mismatch, where the skills of workers do not fit the skills needed in the workplace. It can become a challenge when workers are not prepared for the changing demands of the job market (International Labour Organization, 2020).

In the Philippines, skills mismatch remains a concern because the labor market continues to change due to technological advancements and the growing demand for specific skills. The Philippine Institute for Development Studies (PIDS) emphasized the need to develop relevant skills and improve the alignment between education, training and labor market demands. PIDS also highlighted the importance of labor market information systems and digital platforms in improving job matching (Philippine Institute for Development Studies, 2024).

Problem Description

College graduates and other job seekers may have difficulty finding jobs that match their skills, qualifications, experience and interests. At the same time, employers may have difficulty finding applicants who have the specific skills needed for their job openings. This creates a gap between job seekers and available job opportunities.

The problem is not simply that some graduates work outside their degree. The bigger concern is whether their skills and qualifications fit the actual requirements of the job. When there is a mismatch, workers may not be fully prepared for the skills required in the workplace especially as job requirements continue to change.

This issue is also being addressed through technology in the Philippines. The Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) has been strengthening labor market information systems, including PhilJobNet to improve job matching and help connect job seekers with employment opportunities. In Davao Region, DOLE XI has also highlighted online employment systems that contain information about job seekers' qualifications and skills and available job vacancies as tools that can help address job and skills mismatch (DOLE, 2024; DOLE XI, 2023).

Proposal Solution

The proposed solution for job-skills mismatch among college graduates and other job seekers is the development of a Digital Job-Matching System. This system is designed to help users find suitable job opportunities by comparing their skills, qualifications, education, experience and career interests with the requirements of available positions.

Job seekers can create a profile containing their educational background, skills, work experience, certifications and career interests. Employers can also provide the skills, qualifications and

experience required for their job openings. The system will then compare the information and recommend job opportunities that closely match the applicant's profile.

The system primarily targets college graduates, job seekers and employers who are looking for a better way to connect job seekers with suitable job opportunities. By using a digital platform, job searching and recruitment can become more organized and efficient. The expected impact of this solution includes better job matching, more efficient job searching, improved recruitment and greater awareness of skills that need to be developed.

Overall, the Digital Job-Matching System provides a technology-based approach to help connect people with suitable employment opportunities based on their actual skills and qualifications.

Conclusion

Job-skills mismatch is a problem that can affect both job seekers and employers. The issue is not simply whether a graduate works in a job related to their degree, but whether their skills, qualifications and experience match the actual requirements of the position.

The proposed Digital Job-Matching System can help address this problem by comparing job seekers' profiles with employer requirements and recommending suitable job opportunities. By improving the connection between people's skills and available jobs, the system can help job seekers find better opportunities while helping employers find candidates whose skills fit their needs.

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